

Every salary, with the band that **explains it.**

Compensation management for 10,000 people across seven countries — one authoritative record of what everyone is paid, and the answers to how the organisation pays them.

EMPLOYEES UNDER MANAGEMENT

10,000

ANNUALISED BASE PAY

\$1.14bn

PAY PERIODS IN THE LEDGER

49,692

SCREENS · ENDPOINTS · ROLES

15 · 58 · 4

Seven questions a spreadsheet cannot answer.

Every one of them is on screen, filterable, and backed by a single query. There is no export step, no pivot table, and no version of the file that someone else is also editing.

#	THE QUESTION	WHAT SALARY OS SAYS TODAY
1	What do we spend on base pay — total, and by country, department, level?	\$1,140,963,472.34 across 9,580 people
2	Who is paid outside their band, and what would it cost to fix?	6,911 people · cost to minimum \$2,479,393
3	What does the compa-ratio distribution look like by department and level?	median 1.28 · p25 1.15 · p75 1.28
4	For the same level in the same location, do groups get paid differently?	unadjusted and level-adjusted, cohort ≥ 5
5	What did the last increase cycle cost?	\$145,577 YTD · avg +6.3%
6	Before I approve this raise, how does it compare to peers?	p25 / median / p75, same level and country
7	What is one person's full pay history — every change, when, why, approved by whom?	the complete effective-dated ledger

AND ONE THE MIGRATION ADDED

Can I trust this data at all?

Nine named checks over the imported organisation, each with a count, an explanation, and a drill-through to the actual people. Passing checks stay on screen, dimmed — a console that hides them is indistinguishable from one that never ran.

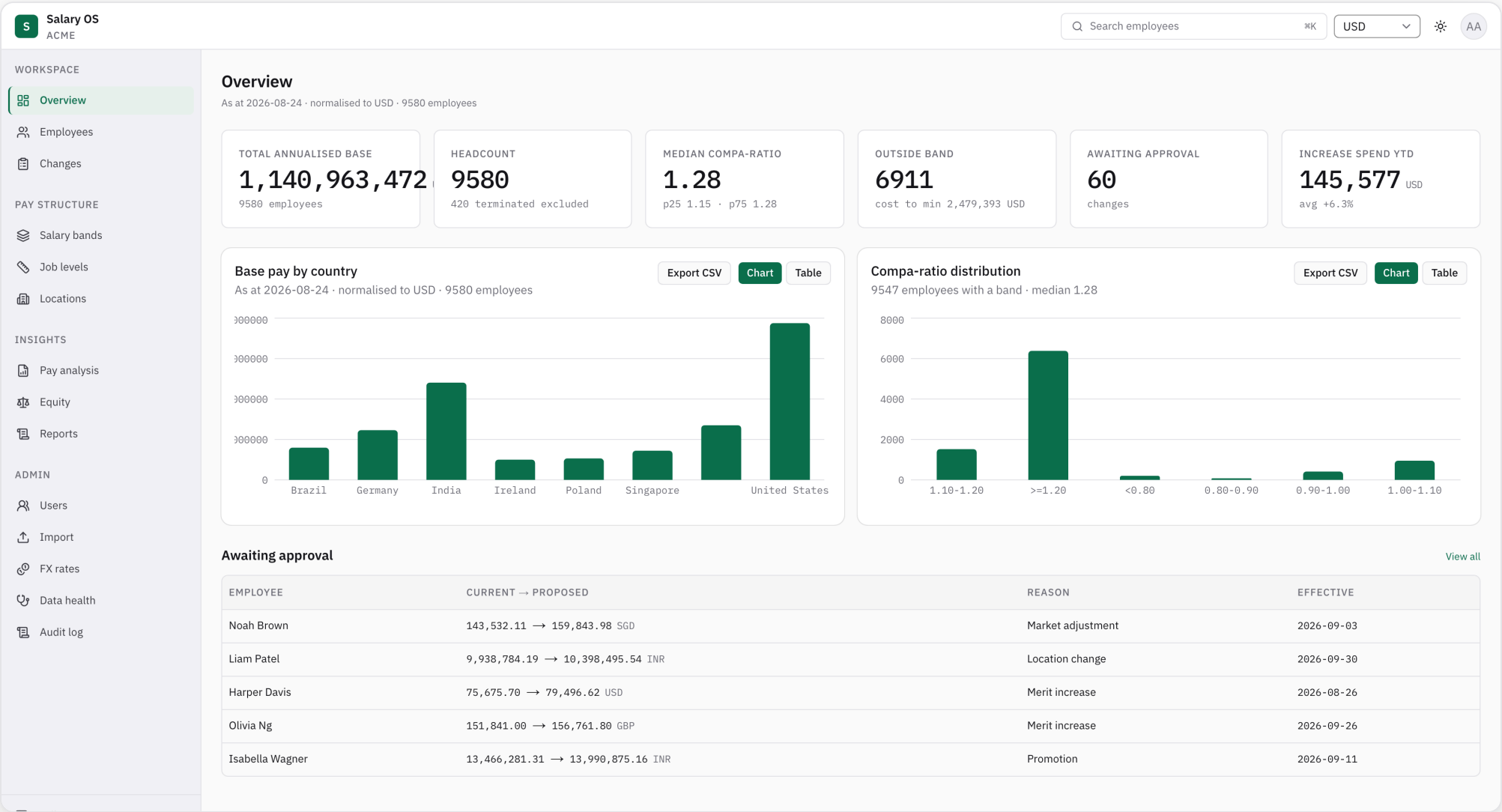
AND ONE THE STRUCTURE ADDED

Is the band structure itself any good?

470 in-force bands judged on range spread, midpoint progression, promotion cliffs, empty bands, and staleness. A gap between adjacent levels is critical; an overlap is normal and is not flagged.

Open it, and the organisation **is already there.**

Six headline figures, spend by country, the compa-ratio distribution, and the approval queue — normalised to one currency, as at today, with no report to run first.



Ten thousand people, one query deep.

- **Real keyset pagination over the full 10k** — not a client-side filter of one page. Page 40 of "worst paid relative to band" is a single server-side query.
- **A result count, not just a Next button.** "50 shown, this filter" — the same screen whether the filter matched 51 people or 5,100 is not an answer you can size.
- **Every filter lives in the URL.** Send a colleague the link and it opens identically.
- **Saved views** store the *question*, never the answer — reopening re-runs it against today's data, with the opener's own permissions.
- **Bulk select** → **propose** a percentage increase for everyone selected. Each new salary is computed server-side, in that person's own currency.
- **CSV export** that always matches the filter on screen.

Salary OS

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50 shown, this filter

Search name, employee #, email

All departments

All locations

All countries

All levels

All statuses

Any band status

Sort: last name

50 / page

No filters — every employee you can see.

Saved views 3 Save this view

☐	NAME	DEPARTMENT	LOCATION	LEVEL	BASE PAY	COMPA-RATIO	BAND	STATUS
☐	Lucas Brown E-06192	Product	Austin	Director of Product	203,963.29 USD	1.05		Active
☐	Jackson Brown E-07515	Sales	Munich	Enterprise Account Executive	99,914.70 EUR	0.92		Active
☐	Freya Brown E-08104	Marketing	London	Marketing Lead	109,627.98 GBP	1.12		Active
☐	Larissa Brown E-06286	Product	Seattle	Staff Designer	152,303.42 USD	1.23		Active
☐	Logan Brown E-03471	Learning & Development	Austin	People Partner	82,936.91 USD	1.15		Active
☐	Noah Brown E-09732	SMB Sales	Dublin	Enterprise Account Executive	135,521.36 EUR	1.28		Active
☐	Larissa Brown E-02623	Enterprise Sales	Delhi	Enterprise Account Executive	11,908,546.04 INR	1.23		Active
☐	Freya Brown E-02058	Product	Singapore	Principal Product Manager	260,722.85 SGD	1.28		Active
☐	Wei Brown E-05950	Legal	New York	Principal Counsel	188,804.97 USD	1.28		Active
☐	Piotr Brown E-05568	Talent Acquisition	San Francisco	Principal People Partner	196,036.90 USD	1.28		Active
☐	Harper Brown E-06349	Sales	Manchester	Account Executive	35,874.34 GBP	1.28		Active
☐	Sophia Brown E-03512	Legal	Berlin	Lead Counsel	144,706.73 EUR	1.28		On leave
☐	Larissa Brown	Product Engineering	New York	Staff Designer	151,303.42 USD	1.23		Active

ROUTE: /EMPLOYEES

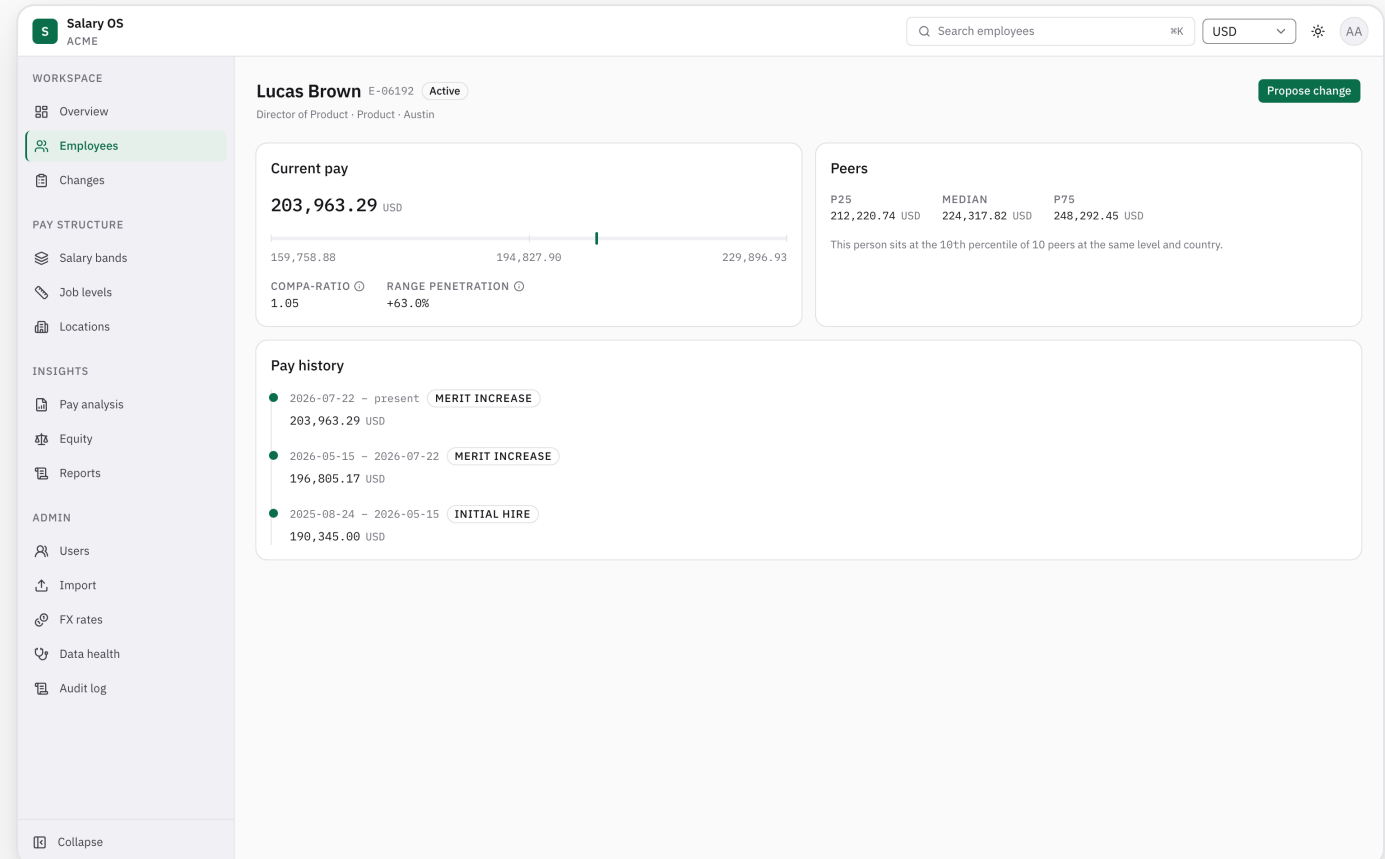
04

A salary shown without its band is an incomplete answer.

Wherever a salary appears, its band appears with it — a track from minimum to maximum, a tick at mid, and a marker where this person actually sits.

<BandBar> · the signature component

- **An out-of-band salary sits outside the track**, overshooting the capped end. Clamping the marker would draw someone paid below minimum as sitting healthily *at* the minimum — the exact error the product exists to surface.
- **"No band" is its own state** — a dashed outline naming what is missing, never a full track with a centred marker inventing a band that does not exist.
- **Peer comparison**: p25 / median / p75 for the same job level and country, and this person's percentile within it.
- **The complete pay history**, newest period first, each row carrying its reason, its proposer, its approver, and the FX rate it was normalised at.



See what the raise does — before you propose it.

The delta, the resulting compa-ratio, where it lands in the band, and what it does to this person's position among their peers. Every figure computed server-side by the same code that would apply the change. Nothing is written by looking.

Lucas Brown

203,963.29

218,500.00

Propose change

Lucas Brown · E-06192

Effective date

01/09/2026

New annual base (USD)

218500

Reason

Merit increase

Performance rating (optional)

Exceeds expectations

Note (optional)

CURRENT → PROPOSED

203,963.29 → 218,500.00 USD

+14,536.71 USD (+7.1%)

COMPA-RATIO

1.05 → 1.12

ANNUALISED COST

+14,536.71 USD

BAND POSITION

Current

Proposed

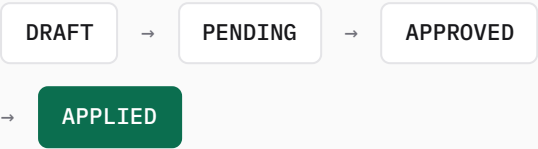
PEER PERCENTILE

10th → 40th of 10 peers

Cancel

Submit for approval

Approved is a promise. **Applied is a fact.**



- **Only APPLIED writes to the ledger.** A raise approved in March effective in July must not appear in June's payroll cost — and it doesn't.
- **The proposer cannot approve their own change.** Enforced server-side, and tested.
- **One non-terminal change per employee.** A second proposal is a rejected duplicate, not a silent one.
- **Bulk merit upload by CSV** and bulk propose from a selection. Partial success is the contract: one person who already has an open change never costs the other thirty-nine their proposals.
- **A daily scheduled job plus an idempotent manual trigger** — because a scheduled job that silently misses a day is how people get paid the wrong amount.

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Proposed compensation changes, by status.

Awaiting approval

Approved

Applied

Rejected

Drafts

EMPLOYEE	CURRENT → PROPOSED	DELTA	EFFECTIVE	REASON	PROPOSER	DECISION
Noah Brown E-02220	143,532.11 → 159,843.98 SGD OUT OF BAND	+16,311.87 SGD (+11.4%)	2026-09-03	Market adjustment	Marcus Manager	Approve Reject
Liam Patel E-05979	9,938,784.19 → 10,398,495.54 INR OUT OF BAND	+459,711.35 INR (+4.6%)	2026-09-30	Location change	Jordan Blake	Approve Reject
Harper Davis E-02687	75,675.70 → 79,496.62 USD OUT OF BAND	+3,820.92 USD (+5.0%)	2026-08-26	Merit increase	Ada Admin	Approve Reject
Olivia Ng E-07694	151,841.00 → 156,761.80 GBP OUT OF BAND	+4,920.80 GBP (+3.2%)	2026-09-26	Merit increase	Marcus Manager	Approve Reject
Isabella Wagner E-09273	13,466,281.31 → 13,990,875.16 INR	+524,593.85 INR (+3.9%)	2026-09-11	Promotion	Ada Admin	Approve Reject
Jorge Kowalski E-00951	194,758.85 → 209,029.24 USD OUT OF BAND	+14,270.39 USD (+7.3%)	2026-09-12	Market adjustment	Marcus Manager	Approve Reject
Sophia Santos E-04986	11,306,894.69 → 12,712,927.25 INR OUT OF BAND	+1,406,032.56 INR (+12.4%)	2026-09-30	Role change	Ada Admin	Approve Reject
Emma Martinez E-03331	9,932,172.48 → 10,307,094.30 INR OUT OF BAND	+374,921.82 INR (+3.8%)	2026-09-18	Merit increase	Jordan Blake	Approve Reject
Zofia Ng E-01311	10,179,083.16 → 10,621,106.39 INR OUT OF BAND	+442,023.23 INR (+4.3%)	2026-09-04	Location change	Ada Admin	Approve Reject
Priya Murphy E-04971	15,043,936.64 → 16,030,707.65 INR OUT OF BAND	+986,771.01 INR (+6.6%)	2026-08-17	Location change	Ana Analyst	Approve Reject
Wei Rodriguez E-09221	6,037,794.91 → 6,433,576.01 INR OUT OF BAND	+395,781.10 INR (+6.6%)	2026-09-29	Promotion	Ada Admin	Approve Reject
Zofia Brown E-05494	235,774.86 → 250,535.33 USD	+14,760.47 USD (+6.3%)	2026-08-23	Location change	Marcus Manager	Approve Reject

470 bands in force — and an opinion about them.

Minimum, mid and maximum per job level per country, effective-dated and versioned. Band health judges the structure rather than merely storing it: range spread, midpoint progression between adjacent levels, promotion cliffs, bands with no incumbents, and staleness.

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Salary bands

Job level × country. Click a filled cell for its version history, or an empty one to create a band.

IN-FORCE BANDS

470

Live today across every level and country.

PROMOTION CLIFFS

1

A band starting above where the level below ends.

NO INCUMBENTS

15

Nobody is paid against them.

STALE (18M+)

0

Not versioned since pay last moved.

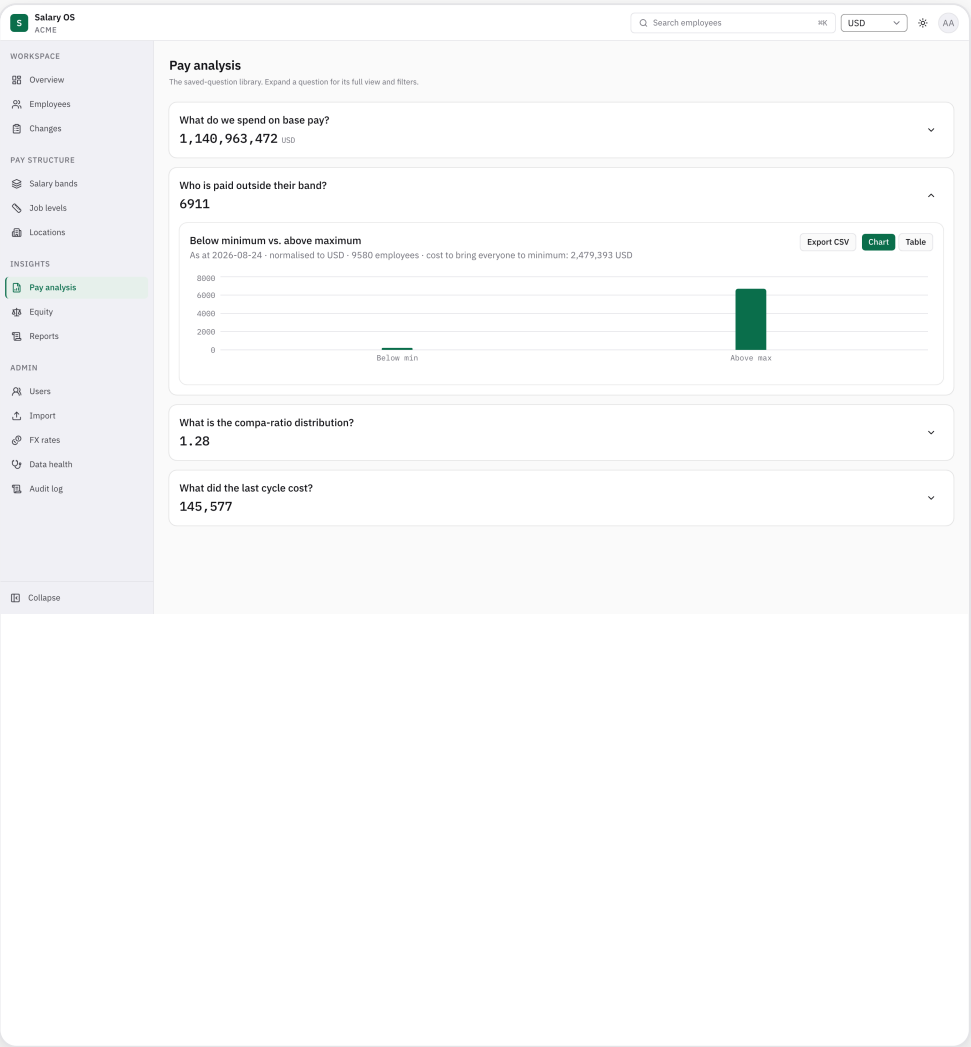
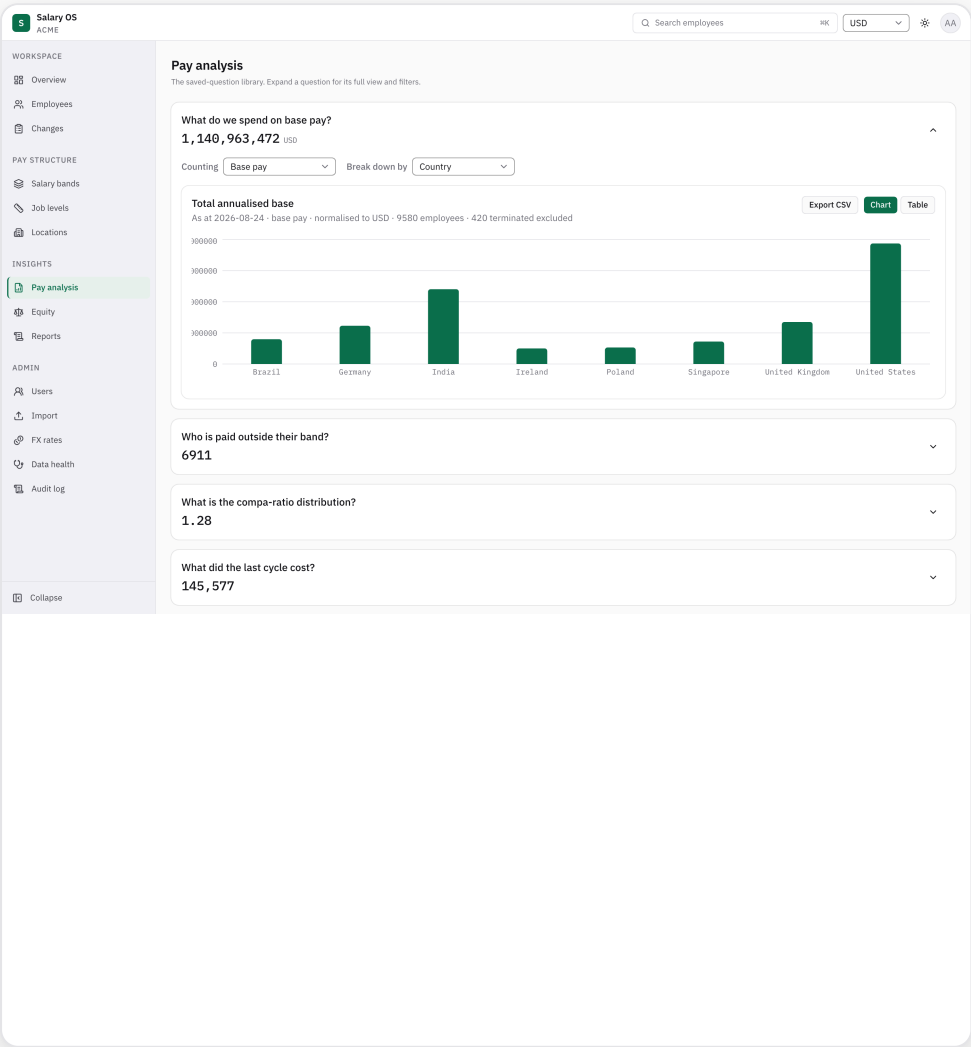
LEVEL	BRAZIL	GERMANY	INDIA	IF
Associate Engineer	239,955.00 – 292,628.05 – 345,301.10 BRL 15 employees	44,264.69 – 53,981.32 – 63,697.96 EUR 22 employees	4,025,068.66 – 4,908,620.32 – 5,792,171.97 INR 47 employees	44 6
Associate Product Manager	231,082.35 – 281,807.75 – 332,533.14 BRL 17 employees	44,793.14 – 54,625.78 – 64,458.42 EUR 17 employees	3,893,121.50 – 4,747,709.14 – 5,602,296.79 INR 42 employees	44 8
Associate Designer	234,694.25 – 286,212.49 – 337,730.74 BRL 6 employees	44,613.26 – 54,406.41 – 64,199.56 EUR 18 employees	4,028,189.75 – 4,912,426.53 – 5,796,663.30 INR 48 employees	44 13
Sales Development Rep	242,966.41 – 296,300.50 – 349,634.59 BRL 13 employees	42,159.28 – 51,413.75 – 60,668.23 EUR 30 employees	3,746,027.47 – 4,568,326.19 – 5,390,624.90 INR 46 employees	44 13
Marketing Associate	236,755.21 – 288,725.86 – 340,696.52 BRL 16 employees	42,639.23 – 51,999.06 – 61,358.89 EUR 25 employees	3,832,796.30 – 4,674,141.83 – 5,515,487.36 INR 54 employees	44 9
People Coordinator	240,554.88 – 293,359.62 – 346,164.35 BRL 20 employees	43,829.00 – 53,450.00 – 63,071.00 EUR 28 employees	3,942,753.20 – 4,808,235.61 – 5,673,718.02 INR 48 employees	44 7
Financial Analyst	235,877.36 – 287,655.31 – 339,433.27 BRL 13 employees	42,469.82 – 51,792.46 – 61,115.11 EUR 20 employees	3,902,669.74 – 4,759,353.35 – 5,616,036.95 INR 43 employees	44 13
Legal Coordinator	226,826.06 – 276,617.15 – 326,408.23 BRL 8 employees	44,168.45 – 53,863.96 – 63,559.47 EUR 27 employees	3,849,870.07 – 4,694,963.50 – 5,540,056.93 INR 50 employees	44 10

ROUTE: /BANDS

08

A saved-question library, not a query box.

Cost, out-of-band, distribution, increase cycle — each a named question with a filterable answer, a chart, a table, and a CSV. The questions are the product; a natural-language layer cannot guarantee the cohort-size filtering the rest of the system enforces in SQL.



Demographics are an absence, not a permission.

- **No endpoint returns a demographic attribute attached to a named person, at any role.**
There is no permission that unlocks it, because there is nothing to unlock.
- **Aggregate only, minimum cohort of five.**
Below that, the group is suppressed.
- **The suppression count is stated unconditionally** — even at zero — so "nothing was suppressed" is a visible, checked fact rather than an absence you have to infer.
- **Unadjusted and level-adjusted gaps are reported separately**, never blended into one number that hides which of the two is doing the work.
- A build-time test fails if a demographic field name appears in any response object outside the analytics package.

The table holding demographic data has **no entity relationship** that could let an ORM fetch drag it into an employee response. The isolation is structural, not a filter someone can forget.

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As at 2026-08-24 · normalised to USD

206 cohorts are not shown here — a group in that level × country pairing had fewer than five people, or only one group was represented at all, so no gap could be shown without risking identifying someone.

Unadjusted

Org-wide median pay by group, ignoring job level entirely — a mix effect (who holds senior roles) can dominate this number.

Export CSV

F

105,596.51 USD

4695 people

M

107,316.51 USD

4717 people

SPREAD (HIGHEST - LOWEST)

1,720.00 USD

+1.6%

Level-adjusted

Median pay by group within each job level × country cohort — a like-for-like comparison, controlling for level by construction.

Export CSV

LEVEL	COUNTRY	GROUPS (MEDIAN · N)	SPREAD
Financial Analyst	Brazil	M: 71,504 (6) · F: 79,676 (7)	8,172 USD (+10.3%)
Associate Product Manager	Brazil	M: 64,515 (5) · F: 75,843 (12)	11,328 USD (+14.9%)
Marketing Associate	Brazil	F: 79,356 (10) · M: 76,812 (6)	2,544 USD (+3.2%)
People Coordinator	Brazil	F: 79,477 (10) · M: 80,596 (10)	1,120 USD (+1.4%)
Operations Associate	Brazil	F: 81,326 (8) · M: 76,033 (9)	5,293 USD (+6.5%)
Marketing Associate	Germany	M: 70,457 (15) · F: 67,954 (10)	2,503 USD (+3.6%)
Operations Associate	Germany	F: 69,967 (12) · M: 71,134 (15)	1,167 USD (+1.6%)
Associate Product Manager	Germany	M: 67,070 (7) · F: 75,038 (10)	7,968 USD (+10.6%)
Associate Engineer	Germany	F: 73,414 (15) · M: 74,071 (7)	657 USD (+0.9%)
Sales Development Rep	Germany	F: 60,572 (17) · M: 68,765 (13)	8,193 USD (+11.9%)
Financial Analyst	Germany	F: 70,510 (10) · M: 72,065 (10)	1,555 USD (+2.2%)

Run the same report twice. Get the same number.

Pay is stored in the currency it is paid in, and normalised at a month-pinned rate stored on the row — never a live one.

Why the figures reconcile

- **Reports never recompute history at today's rate.** A number that changes between two runs destroys trust in every other number on the page.
- **The topbar toggles every figure on screen** between "as paid" and normalised.
- **Responses report the FX span** they were normalised over — a population of 9,580 people has no single governing rate month, so the answer says how many it used.
- **A coverage matrix** shows currency × month, so you can see which months payroll cannot yet be written for *before* a report comes back short.
- **A money value never travels without its currency code.** There is no bare amount field in any response, anywhere.

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FX rates

One pinned rate per currency and month. Reports never recompute at today's rate (CLAUDE.md §6.4).

Missing months

BRL → USD 2026-11-01 + Add

EUR → USD 2026-11-01 + Add

GBP → USD 2026-11-01 + Add

INR → USD 2026-11-01 + Add

PLN → USD 2026-11-01 + Add

SGD → USD 2026-11-01 + Add

USD → USD 2026-11-01 + Add

BRL → USD 2026-10-01 + Add

EUR → USD 2026-10-01 + Add

GBP → USD 2026-10-01 + Add

INR → USD 2026-10-01 + Add

PLN → USD 2026-10-01 + Add

SGD → USD 2026-10-01 + Add

USD → USD 2026-10-01 + Add

BRL → USD 2026-09-01 + Add

EUR → USD 2026-09-01 + Add

GBP → USD 2026-09-01 + Add

INR → USD 2026-09-01 + Add

PLN → USD 2026-09-01 + Add

SGD → USD 2026-09-01 + Add

Coverage

Only the currencies people are actually paid in. A currency nobody is on cannot block a write.

20 months are missing a rate into USD. A compensation record dated an uncovered month cannot be written until its rate is pinned.

CURRENCY	PEOPLE	Aug 2025	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec	Jan 2026	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov
BRL	631																
EUR	1429																
GBP	1208																
INR	1963																
PLN	465																
SGD	633																
USD	3251																

Pinned rates

MONTH	FROM	TO	RATE
2026-09-01	USD	USD	1.00000000
2026-08-01	BRL	USD	0.22172757
2026-08-01	EUR	USD	1.06645949

ROUTE: /ADMIN/FX-RATES

11

The first job of a migration is finding what the spreadsheet got wrong.

Every other screen assumes the data is right and answers a question with it. Data health asks whether the data can carry the question at all — nine named checks, each with a severity, a count, an explanation, and a drill-through to the actual people.

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Data health

As at 2026-08-24 · 9,580 employees, terminated excluded

2 of 9 checks found something.

SEVERITY	CHECK	AFFECTED	
WARNING	Reporting to a terminated manager The org chart and every manager rollup are wrong for these people.	357	See the 357 employees
WARNING	Employees with no matching salary band No compa-ratio can be computed, so they fall out of band analysis.	33	See the 33 employees

PASSING (7)

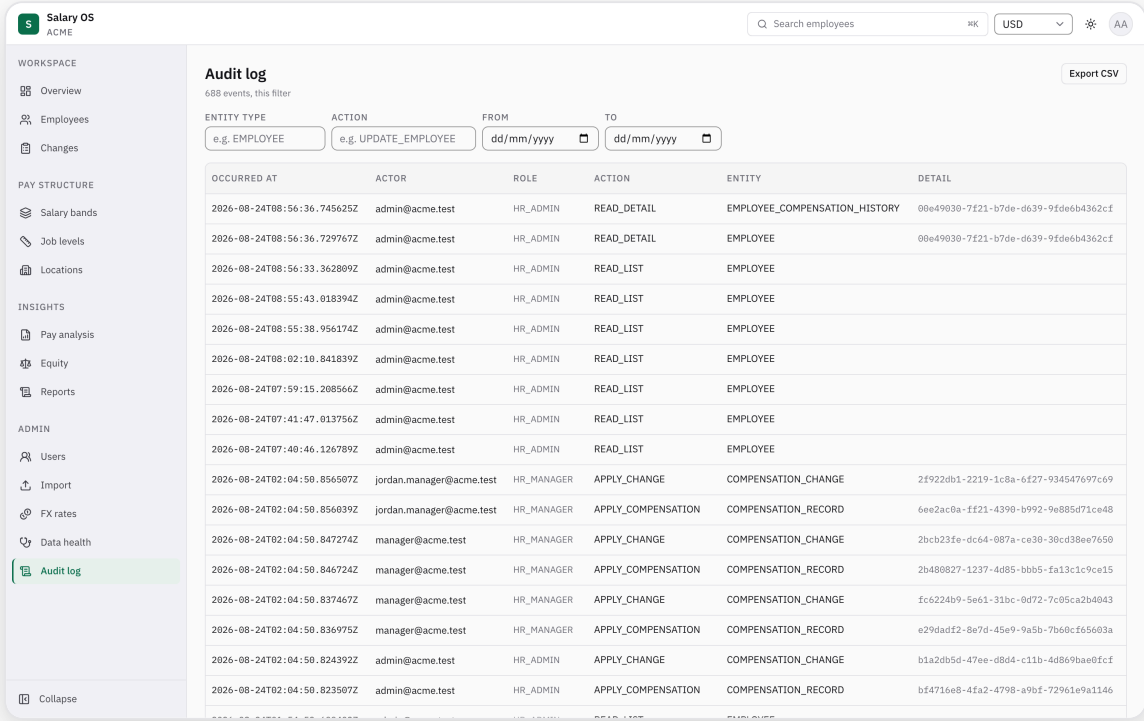
0	Active employees with no pay record
0	Terminated employees still being paid
0	Pay starting before the hire date
0	Circular management chains
0	Level or location changed since pay last did
0	Full-time employees below 1.0 FTE
0	Paid in a non-default currency for their country

Four flat roles. No hierarchy, on purpose.

CAPABILITY	HR ADMIN	HR MGR	ANALYST	AUDITOR
Manage users & roles	●	○	○	○
View employees & their pay	●	●	●	●
Create / edit employee record	●	●	○	○
Propose a compensation change	●	●	●	○
Approve / reject a change	●	●	○	○
Manage salary bands & levels	●	●	○	○
Run insights (aggregate)	●	●	●	○
Import / bulk upload	●	○	○	○
Read the audit log	●	○	○	●

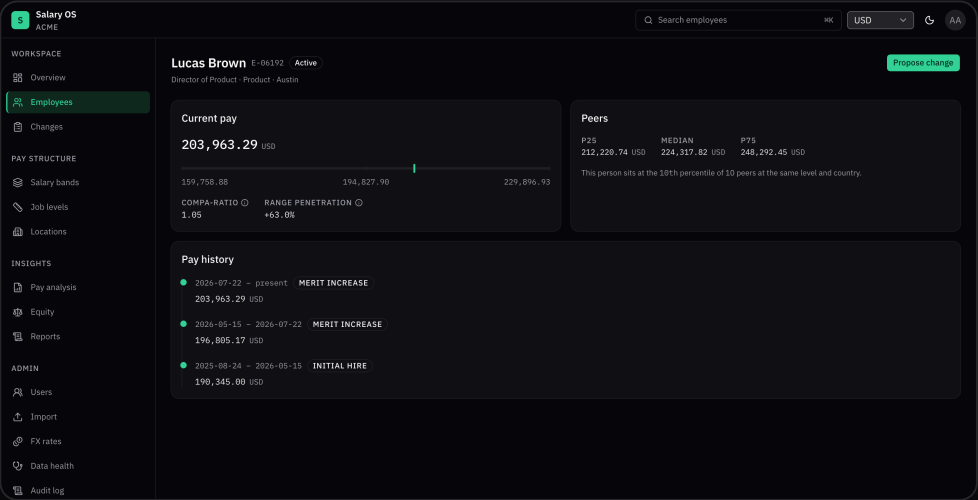
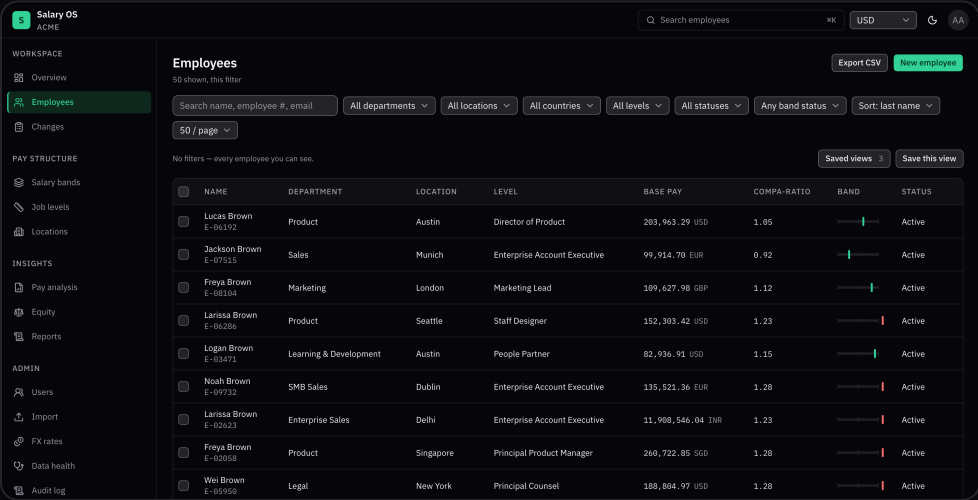
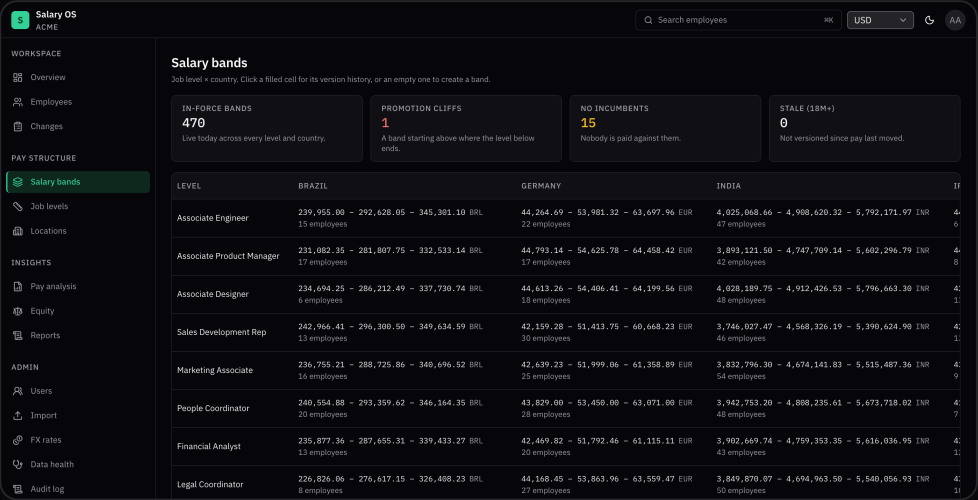
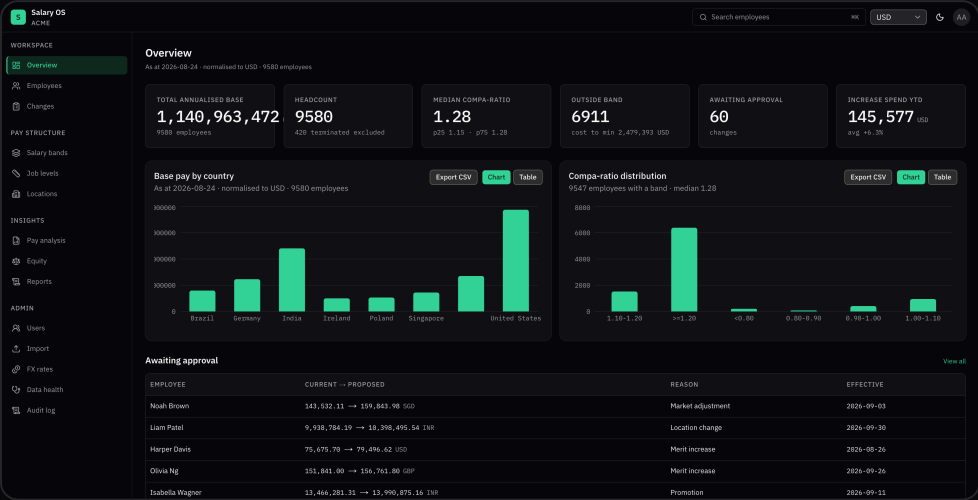
- **HR Admin is deliberately not implicitly allowed everything.** A role is permitted only where it is typed out on the endpoint — and a test mirrors this table and fails the build if the two drift.
- **Every read of individual pay data is audited**, not only writes. "Who looked at what salaries" cannot be answered retroactively.
- **Sessions:** a signed JWT in an HttpOnly cookie, 20-minute life, 12-hour refresh rotated on every use with reuse detection, double-submit CSRF. No token ever reaches JavaScript. No third-party identity provider anywhere in the system.

ROUTES: /ADMIN/USERS · /ADMIN/AUDIT



Two themes, one set of tokens.

IBM Plex Sans throughout, IBM Plex Mono with tabular numerals for every figure — in a compensation tool the numerals *are* the display type, so columns of money align on the decimal without any extra work. Both themes are driven entirely from CSS variables; no component contains a raw colour value.



Eight rules, each one there because **breaking it fails silently.**

Money is exact, and computed once

NUMERIC(15,2) in the database, BigDecimal in Java — never a float, never a JavaScript number doing arithmetic. The browser formats; it does not calculate.

Compensation is insert-only

A change closes the current period and opens a new one. A mistake is corrected by a new row marked CORRECTION, never by editing history — and a Postgres exclusion constraint makes overlapping pay periods impossible to insert at all.

Demographics are isolated

Aggregate, cohort of five or more, or not at all. Enforced by structure and by a build-time test.

Effective dates are calendar dates

Event times are UTC instants. Storing an effective date as a timestamp puts raises a day early for half the organisation.

A money value never travels alone

Amount and currency are one pair, in every response, without exception.

Normalisation uses a pinned rate

Every record stores the rate it was normalised at, so a report is reproducible years later.

Every read of pay data is audited

Not only writes. The question auditors ask is who *looked*.

Tested against a real database

Every test runs on real PostgreSQL 17 via Testcontainers, never an embedded stand-in that would pass while production fails.

BACKEND

206

tests, 0 failures — real Postgres 17

FRONTEND

45

tests, 0 failures — lint, typecheck and build clean

EMPLOYEE LIST, FULL 10K

17–21ms

p95, against a 400 ms budget

What we **deliberately** did not build.

The exclusions are part of the design, not gaps in it. Each one is a decision with a reason attached.

Payroll execution, payslips, tax filing

Salary OS is the upstream source of truth that *feeds* payroll, not a replacement for it.

Benefits, equity grants, time & attendance

Total-rewards modelling is only meaningful once base pay is trustworthy.

Live FX rates

A report whose numbers change between two runs is not a report.

Employee self-service

Opening pay data to 10,000 people changes the threat model for a use case nobody asked for.

Configurable multi-level approval chains

Configurable workflow engines are where compensation tools go to die.

A free-text "ask anything about pay" assistant

A natural-language layer cannot guarantee the cohort-size filtering the rest of the product enforces in SQL.

BACKEND

Spring Boot 4.0.8 · Spring
Security 7

DATABASE

PostgreSQL 17 · Flyway ·
Argon2id

FRONTEND

Next.js 16 · shadcn/ui ·
Tailwind v4

ARCHITECTURE

A modular monolith,
deliberately